



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Consumer sentiment** in the U.S. sank this month, as worries intensify over what the tariffs, government layoffs, funding cuts and immigration restrictions that Trump has introduced might mean for the economy. **A1**
- ◆ **Companies that import** and distribute fruits and vegetables are canceling orders and sometimes replacing them within days as they navigate rapid shifts in Trump's tariff policy. **B9**
- ◆ **Foxconn reported** weaker-than-expected quarterly results but forecast a strong 2025 as the contract electronics maker continues diversifying its business. **B9**
- ◆ **Tesla is developing** a lower-cost Model Y SUV that would debut in China. **B10**
- ◆ **Beijing has signaled** its displeasure over CK Hutchison's agreement to sell its majority controlling stake in Panama ports to a BlackRock-led consortium. **B11**
- ◆ **Gold exceeded \$3,000** a troy ounce for the first time on economic uncertainty and safe-haven demand. **B11**
- ◆ **U.S. stock indexes** rallied, cutting their weekly losses roughly in half as the threat of a government shutdown eased. The S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq rose 2.1%, 1.7% and 2.6%, respectively. **B11**

World-Wide

- ◆ **A group of 10 Democrats** led by Sen. Chuck Schumer helped Republicans advance a bill to fund the government, averting a shutdown but leaving Democrats divided on how to resist Trump's agenda. The Senate later passed the bill in a final vote, largely along party lines. **A1, A4**
- ◆ **A Columbia University** student left the country this past week after the State Department revoked the person's visa. **A3**
- ◆ **Mired in operational** and legal challenges, Trump's plan to send the "worst criminal illegal aliens" to Guantanamo Bay is unraveling. **A5**
- ◆ **The U.S. military** has been playing a behind-the-scenes diplomatic role in Syria, helping broker deals between militia groups and the new government. **A8**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** rejected a Hamas offer to release the last living American hostage and the bodies of four others in exchange for Israeli concessions. **A8**
- ◆ **Trump and Putin** painted a rosy picture of talks to end to the war in Ukraine, while Kyiv urged the U.S. to exert pressure on Russia after the Kremlin rejected a cease-fire. **A9**
- ◆ **Mark Carney took over** as Canada's prime minister, amid a trade war with Trump, and likely kicking off a national election. **A10**

NOONAN
'The Jungle' is a cautionary tale for DOGE **A15**

CONTENTS	
Obituaries.....	C6
Books.....	C7-12
Opinion.....	A13-15
Business&Fin.....	B9-10
Sports.....	A12
Design & Decor.....	D6-8
Style & Fashion.....	D2-3
Food.....	D9-10
Travel.....	D11-12
Heard on Street.....	B12
U.S. News.....	A2-6
Markets.....	B11
World News.....	A8-10



Consumer Sentiment Sours

Uncertainty around the economy, tariffs, funding cuts and jobs begins to take a toll

By JUSTIN LAHART
AND ED FRANKL

Consumer sentiment in the U.S. sank this month, as worries intensify over what the tariffs, government layoffs, funding cuts and immigration restrictions that President Trump has introduced might

mean for the economy.

The University of Michigan's closely watched index of consumer sentiment nosedived another 11% to 57.9 in mid-March from 64.7 last month, continuing a downward trend that has taken hold since Trump took office.

That marked the lowest level since November 2022, and was much weaker than the 63.2 that economists polled by The Wall Street Journal expected. Compared with a year earlier, consumer sentiment is down 27%.

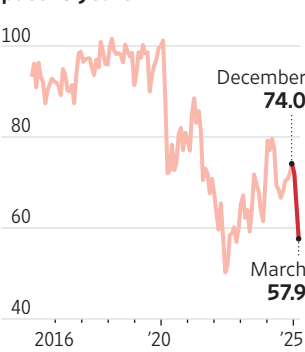
Pantheon Macroeconomics economist Samuel Tombs called the report "horrific" in a research note, adding that "elevated economic policy uncertainty and the sharp drop in stock prices have greatly undermined consumers' confidence."

Stocks have been falling for much of the past several weeks as investors try to parse

Please turn to page A2

- ◆ **Greg Ip: How Wall Street got Trump wrong.....** A2
- ◆ **Indicators for early signs of a recession.....** A2

Consumer-sentiment index, past 10 years



Source: University of Michigan via LSEG

Blood Moon Eclipse Puts on Celestial Show

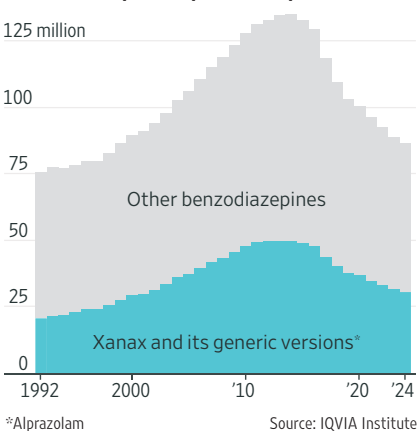


SEEING RED: A total lunar eclipse was visible between Chicago skyscrapers early Friday. The rare spectacle occurs when the sun, Earth and moon line up. Bits of sunlight filter through Earth's atmosphere and bend toward the moon, making it look red.

The Dark Side of America's Xanax Habit

Quitting benzodiazepines can cause extreme anxiety, memory loss and physical pain

Annual U.S. prescriptions dispensed



*Alprazolam

Source: IQVIA Institute

By SHALINI RAMACHANDRAN
AND BETSY MCKAY

Two years after she started taking Xanax, Dana Bare began having panic attacks like never before.

Her memory started slipping. Her husband had to remind her how to make a sandwich. Bare's ailments cycled her through emergency rooms and puzzled specialists, some of whom thought she was mentally ill or had cancer. No one knew what to do other than up her Xanax dose, to 2 milligrams a day at one point.

The popular pills had been a blessing at first when her general practitioner prescribed them for mild insomnia

more than a decade ago. Bare was a busy mother of five running a charity based in Smith County, Tenn. Xanax helped sleep come easy.

Over time, though, her nervous system developed a debilitating physical dependence on the drug. When she tried to quit after five years, crippling symptoms consumed her. "Brain zaps" hit her like electric shocks. Shower water jolted her so badly that she would suffer panic attacks and at times writhe in pain until she passed out.

"Never forget how much I have always loved you, but don't spend too much time missing me," Bare wrote to her oldest daughter in 2018, when she

Please turn to page A11

Carmakers Are Reinventing The Gear Shifter. Drivers Are Lost.

From touch screens to crystal balls, designers put the controls almost anywhere

By RYAN FELTON
AND CHRISTINA ROGERS

Sean O'Malley has driven hundreds of cars during his nearly four-decade career as a vehicle tester. But one day a couple of years ago he found himself in the seat of a Hyundai at a loss over how to get the car to move.

O'Malley, senior test coordinator at the Insurance Institute for Highway

Safety, and his colleagues couldn't find the gear shifter in the Ioniq 5 sport-utility vehicle. One of them finally spotted it tucked away behind the steering wheel.

"It was definitely not obvious where it was," O'Malley said.

Car shoppers, car renters and valets feel O'Malley's pain. A proliferation of electronic controls have allowed car engineers to

Please turn to page A6



Netflix, Amazon and Peacock Bet Big on Popular YouTubers

By JESSICA TOONKEL

YouTube creators are beginning to get their Hollywood moment.

Streamers including Netflix, NBCUniversal's Peacock and Amazon.com are wooing web creators—and their legions of fans—for new series or spinoffs, courting a category of performers whose fare rarely used to make the jump to subscription streaming services. The change is a sign of Google-owned YouTube's tightening grip on America's TV time.

While Netflix and others began to reach out to YouTubers seeking deals more than a year

ago, interest shifted into overdrive after the knockout success of MrBeast's "Beast Games," which premiered on Amazon Prime Video in December. Amazon made a profit of at least \$100 million on the show, according to people familiar with the situation, and is negotiating a deal for the second and third seasons of the hit.

In the U.S., nearly one in four people who watched Prime Video in the four weeks after the series started watched an episode of "Beast Games," according to one of the people. Of those, 60% watched at least three episodes.

Netflix debuted a show by

Schumer Helps GOP Head Off Federal Shutdown

WASHINGTON—A group of Senate Democrats led by Sen. Chuck Schumer helped Republicans approve a bill Friday to fund the government through September, averting a shutdown but leaving Democrats deeply divided on how to resist President Trump's "shock-and-awe" agenda.

By Lindsay Wise,
Siobhan Hughes
And Katy Stech Ferek

The chamber's Democratic leader and nine other members of the party's caucus broke with most of their party to back the \$1.7 trillion funding measure, moving it forward on a 62-38 tally, above the required 60-vote threshold for most Senate bills. One Republican, Sen. Rand Paul of Kentucky, voted no.

In the subsequent final vote that required only a simple majority, the Senate approved the bill 54-46, largely along party lines. It now goes to Trump's desk for his signature.

The result in the Senate, where Republicans have a 53-47 majority, underscored how little power Democrats have to resist Trump's plans and fueled rising frustration in party ranks over its direction and leadership. In his whirlwind first 50 days in office, Trump has moved to sharply trim the federal workforce and rein in foreign aid while setting the stage for a multitrillion-dollar package of tax cuts, spending reductions and border spending later this year.

Schumer, a New York lawmaker who faced heavy criticism all day from his own party, said the bill was the best

Please turn to page A4

- ◆ **Why Schumer broke with Democrats.....** A4

EXCHANGE



'PRETTY NEGATIVE'
The week the smart money got whipsawed by the market. **B1**